

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, April 27, 2022, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward II Councilor James Contois
Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor William Limoges (Via Phone)
At-Large Councilor Lucas Beliveau
At-Large Councilor Matthew Mooshian
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

John MacLean, Interim City Manager
Lisa Richmond, Finance Director

AGENDA CHANGES

Councilor Stone asked the Council to add a non-public meeting under RSA 91-A:3 II(c); Matters which, if discussed in public, would likely affect adversely the reputation of any person, other than a member of the public body itself. Councilor Stone recommended the non-public meeting be added to the end of the regularly scheduled Council meeting.

Mr. MacLean asked the Council to remove item B. under New Business “AFSME Contract/Authorize City Manager to Execute.”

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept the minutes of the April 13, 2022, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: Motion carried 9-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Mayor Girard noted there was a sign put up over the weekend at the Transfer Station. Mayor Girard stated the Transfer Station is not on tonight's agenda, it was discussed at the April 13th Council meeting, and the Council requested the City Manager to send out requests for proposals. A wide range of options were discussed during this conversation, Mr. MacLean noted during that April 13th Council meeting it would take forty-five to sixty days to receive any proposals back. Once these proposals are back, it will take time to review. Mayor Girard pointed out that no decisions or actions have been made relative to the Transfer Station, and once the information comes back the City will hold a meeting for public input. Mayor Girard also commented this is a very important topic to many people in this community, and suggested more information should come out around July.

Mayor Girard received a note from the Claremont Lead Action Team who has been working with other agencies, HB1421 was passed in the House and has been moved into the Senate. This will allow schools and childcare facilities to install water bottle filling stations. Mayor Girard noted this follows what the Council started back in 2016 for getting lead out of pipes and schools for our community. The HB1421 will be heard in the Senate tomorrow, and Mayor Girard wanted to make the Council aware.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. MacLean shared with the Council that he is anticipating in this year's budget having projects associated with roof repair on City Hall. Mr. MacLean suggested going out early for a bid, but recognizing this does not mean accepting the bid before the budget itself is accepted. Mr. MacLean noted his concern for contractors being very busy and waiting longer could delay roof repairs until next winter. Mr. MacLean stated this would not obligate the City and the City would not award any bid until after the budget is adopted. Or, if the Council does not adopt this particular portion of the budget, the City will not go forward with these repairs at this time.

Mr. MacLean suggested at the last Council meeting that the result of changes relative to Pleasant Street created a savings of \$19,000.00. However, after re-examination by the engineers, who had to add granite to support flowers and other ornamentals, the project did not save \$19,000.00 instead the project spent \$260.00.

Mr. MacLean shared a cost sheet with information relative to Casella vs. the Claremont Transfer Station. This cost sheet showed comparisons between Casella's schedule and Claremont's schedule. Mr. MacLean iterated that this is not a topic on tonight's agenda but wanted to share the information with Council who shared concerns for cost comparisons. Mr. MacLean also noted that the Public Works Director, Alex Gleeson shared there is still approximately \$18,000.00 of maintenance cost for well monitors and vegetation control.

Budget documents are being delivered this Friday. Council can begin their review and ultimately start the process of examining the budget by department, line item by line item.

Mr. MacLean reminded the Council this is Doree's last week. There will be a small reception for Doree at City Hall Friday from 2 p.m. to 3 p.m., Mr. MacLean asked everyone to please stop by to wish her well if they can.

Mr. MacLean concluded the Manager's Report by sharing with the Council that West Claremont Center for Music and Arts is applying for a USDA grant for equipment. Mr. MacLean noted they do not need any obligation from the City. The West Claremont Center for Music and Arts is looking for the City to be aware of the grant application and support of it. Mr. MacLean expressed the City will not receive any grant money, but will sign to recognize our support.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Robert Davis, Ward 1, is a resident on Sugar River Drive, who has lived there for fifty years. Mr. Davis shared with the Council that he has witnessed this road deteriorate significantly over time. Mr. Davis noted there has been substantial development of mobile homes in the area including Case Hill Road, Alden Hill Road, Sugar River Drive, and Puckershire Avenue. With all of this development in housing Mr. Davis stated there hasn't been any major improvements to the roads. Mr. Davis stated he spoke to the Department of Public Works Assistant Director and explained to him the heavy traffic that rides through Sugar River Drive. Mr. Davis explained a milk truck that travels once sometimes twice a day, along with a grain truck, and farm equipment that travels weekly. Mr. Davis stated the City is not doing its due diligence. Mr. Davis compared the milk truck equivalency to 16,000 vehicles a day traveling that road. Mr. Davis commented that the condition of this road is "sacrilegious." Mr. Davis noted the solution has been to pour gravel on tar road, and noted only after a few days, and especially after the rain the road conditions are unacceptable while creating many pot-holes and rough areas. Mr. Davis shared concern for accidents and for the speed at which cars travel along the first and last section of Sugar River Drive. Mr. Davis shared an experience his wife had while walking their dog on Sugar River Drive; that a car was traveling so fast she had to jump out of the way. Mr. Davis told the Council these concerns have been discussed with the Police Department. Mr. Davis commented he only sees a Police Presence one to two times after making a complaint.

Clinton Lawry, Ward 2, noted his respect to the City Councilors' and their civic services in Claremont. Mr. Lawry expressed he strongly disagrees with closing the Transfer Station. Mr. Lawry noted the workers do a great job of making the Transfer Station look good and they are courteous. Mr. Lawry shared these services are not free, he pays \$20.00 per ticket. On Tuesday April 19th, Mr. Lawry's neighbor gave him a copy of Valley News which read: City Moves to Privatize Transfer Station. Mr. Lawry suggested increasing the bag price instead of privatization, and questioned why the City has not consulted with the taxpayers and citizens of Claremont. Mr. Lawry stated this is a dictatorial pushover, and does not think it's fair when a

Council member makes a comment about the burden of paying for others' trash. Mr. Lawry stated his taxes go to many departments and facilities that he does not personally use but is willing to pay to keep them open. Mr. Lawry stated Claremont needs the Transfer Station so citizens can recycle and throw away their trash at a fair price.

Norm Blouin ward 3, Started his forum by sharing with the Council that in his opinion, the Smokestack should be torn down. Mr. Blouin asked the Council what happened to the notes in the minute's relative to the Transfer Station advocate group that met here at the last Council meeting. Mr. Blouin stated this group has traveled from Keene to Lebanon to look at other Transfer Station facilities. Mr. Blouin stated there is Pick up on Wednesdays for the City and directly asked Mr. MacLean if this was charged back to the City departments or the Transfer Station. Ms. Richmond explained that the employees during time of pick-up are Transfer Station employees, salary and benefits are being charged back to the Transfer Station. Mr. Blouin asked for a line item of expenses for the next meeting. Ms. Richmond shared this was in the budget that is posted, but can get this information. Mr. Blouin expressed concern that the Department of Public Works Director is not doing their job. Mr. Blouin started speaking on the topic of Steel Mill Solar, at this time Mayor Girard asked Mr. Blouin to stick to non-agenda items. Mr. Blouin continued to speak on Steel Mill Solar. Mr. Blouin noted the budget continues to go up but the maintenance gets poorer. Mr. Blouin stated the City is hiring employees from out of town but we are spending money training them. Mr. Blouin started to share concern for roads. Councilor O'Hearne stated Mr. Blouin's 5-minute time is up for Citizen Forum, Mr. Blouin continued on speaking.

At 6:58 p.m. Mayor Girard called for a 5-minute recess.

At 7:03 p.m. Mayor Girard called the meeting back into session from a recess. Mayor Girard stated if anyone who wants to speak during Citizens Forum that they do not direct a question to be answered by the City Manager, and instead address the Council.

John Mosher Ward, 3, spoke in favor of keeping the Transfer Station as is. Mr. Mosher expressed the Transfer Station does a good job, and many citizens are pleased how organized and efficient it is. Mr. Mosher suggested to the Council having a modest fee increase. Mr. Mosher stated those who don't want to use the Transfer Station have the option to use a private service.

Earnest Montenegro, Ward 1, has lived in Claremont for 30 years. Mr. Montenegro explained to the Council the Transfer Station is a great place to have and to privatize it would be foolish. Mr. Montenegro is not willing to pay for a private service. Mr. Montenegro expressed to the Council there should be a public meeting and then a vote.

Donna Montenegro, Ward 1, relayed to the Council she appreciates that the Council is trying to be fiscally responsible by privatizing the Transfer Station, but does not agree with it. Mrs. Montenegro noted the Newport facility has a zero-sort recycling and is not environmentally responsible. Mrs. Montenegro shared concern for citizens dumping their trash in the woods as some won't be able to afford the fee increase if we privatize. Mrs. Montenegro Suggested to the

Council that volunteers could help make the Transfer Station profitable, she concluded her forum by stating she appreciates all the work the Council does.

Mike Tetu, Ward 1, stated the Council has not voted to privatize, instead the Council asked the City Manager to request proposals for privatization. Mr. Tetu explained he feels the Council is listening to the citizens of Claremont. Mr. Tetu noted the fees at Casella are almost double the price of what Claremont pays. Mr. Tetu believes we can keep the fee at \$0.15 a pound, and doesn't think the request for proposals is necessary and is requesting the Council to table the RFP for the Transfer station.

Councilor Koloski had a few comments from what transpired in Council Chambers before taking a recess. Councilor Koloski shared with everyone there are newly installed listening devices for those who have a hard time hearing, these devices are available for use. Councilor Koloski reiterated the statement made by Mayor Girard at the beginning of the Council meeting that the Transfer Station will not be discussed on tonight's agenda, The Council has not made any decisions on the Transfer station. He noted there will be a public hearing once we get final numbers on the Transfer Station. Councilor Koloski then asked the City Manager for actual figures of what the City pays to recycle out of the facility. Councilor Koloski concludes by stating there is a process in place for requesting public information; filling out a form through the City's website or calling the City Manager's office.

Councilor Stone relayed to the public that upon receiving any information for the Transfer Station it will be released to the public.

Councilor Contois noted the terms "Lay-off, privatize, and close" have been used by Council relative to the Transfer Station.

Assistant Mayor Matteau replied these terms can be pulled out of context. She noted there was never a vote to close the Transfer Station. Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the Council voted to put a request of proposal out for privatization not vote to privatize. Assistant Mayor Matteau also expressed not appreciating people cutting-down City workers and their hard work.

OLD BUSINESS

Steel Mill Solar Update

Mr. MacLean noted the Council has not re-appointed an Energy Advisory Committee; this capacity is now held by the City Council. Planning and Development Director, Nancy Merrill, introduced Executive Director of Clean Energy, Sam Evens-Brown to further explain Municipal Solar Energy. Mr. Brown shared a PowerPoint with the Council.

Kevin Tyson, Ward 2, stated in Mr. Brown's explanation of funding there were several instances where there is a fair amount of government action that has affected the price in the past, and can affect the price of the future. Mr. Tyson would like to see this in a report for comparisons. Mr.

Tyson also shared he lives close to Grissom Lane and it is a very windy location, he asked if this has been taken into consideration.

Mayor Girard asked for a Copy of this presentation to be sent to Council

Mr. MacLean suggested the Council should re-establish the Energy Advisory Committee.

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor Limoges to return all energy pieces presented back to City Council.

Mr. MacLean explained a motion isn't necessary, being absent an Energy Advisory Committee, the Council will continue to receive all information relative to energy.

Councilor Stone withdrew his motion; Councilor Limoges withdrew his motion.

Mr. Blouin, shared with the Council he has a solar array, Mr. Blouin mentioned these styles are good for areas with very little wind. Mr. Blouin objects to where we want to put the Solar Mill Project with concern for using agricultural land.

Sullivan Tower Stack & Pump House Discussion

At the March City Council meeting there was a discussion of the condition of the Sullivan Machine stack. The Council requested further information on potential grant funding.

There are three options that have been discussed. One is to demolish in its entirety, one is to save a portion of the stack, and the last is to save the structure as is. If the last two options are under consideration there are a few grant opportunities.

As a contributing structure in the historic district the stack and pump house would be eligible for LCHIP funding, however it requires 1) 50% match in funds, and 2) an historic structure report or other plan if the request for funding is greater than \$50,000. LCHIP does fund historic reports and the City could apply for that funding in the current LCHIP round.

We have had an opportunity to also investigate a municipal assistance program offered by the University of Connecticut Technical Assistance for Brownfields Program (TAB). The summer program would offer technical support on brownfields redevelopment including site reuse assessment and community engagement. The fall program would offer technical support on EPA brownfield grant applications.

We recommend that the Council consider a larger community planning & grant effort for the city parcels on the North side of the river, including the stack and pump house and surrounding lands and support an application to UConn-TAB for both summer and fall programs. While consideration is being given to the three options for the tower, one of the recommendations in the Structural report is to remove the top 16'. This might be a

prudent next step if the city wants to continue the discussion on use of the property and possible remediation or redevelopment efforts. Otherwise, the city can go out bid for demolition.

Ms. Merrill stated the top 16 feet of the Smokestack does need to come down, Ms. Merrill has asked for information on a temporary cap, and noted the estimates from reports are only relative to the Smokestack not the adjacent buildings.

Mr. Blouin shared concern with the bricks on the chimney holding together and suggested it will need to be sprayed every three years. Mr. Blouin would like to see a grant to fund a riverwalk, and to demolish the Smokestack.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Beliveau to authorize the City Manager to enter into agreement at no cost to the City with the University of Connecticut Technical Assistance for Brownfields Program

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Beliveau to seek bids for the demolition of the top 16 feet of the Sullivan Smokestack vs. the complete demolition of the Sullivan Smokestack, and seek information on the appropriate cap.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2022-25 Emergency Operations Plan (EOP) Update Grant and Continuity of Operations (COOP) EMPG Grant Project – Public Hearing

WHEREAS, the Council previously approved and adopted Resolution 2021-29 (Emergency Operation Plan Update) and Resolution 2022-19 (Continuity of Operations (COOP) EMPG Grant Project);

WHEREAS, the governmental funding sources for both grants prefer that this authorization and appropriation for these two grants occur by and through a single resolution of the Claremont City Council;

WHEREAS, the primary goal of developing a Continuity of Operations Plan (COOP) and Emergency Operations Plan (EOP) is to ensure the protection of life and property during times of emergency and the City of Claremont is scheduled to update its COOP and EOP; and

WHEREAS, the City would like approval to apply for, accept, and expend an award of the New Hampshire Homeland Security and Emergency Management Grant in the amount of Twenty-Two Thousand Dollars (\$22,000.00) for the purpose of updating and reformatting the City's Continuity of Operations Plan and Local Emergency Operations Plan to meet Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) criteria,

WHEREAS, the total sum of these two grants requires the City to authorize and appropriate the amount Eleven Thousand Dollars (\$11,000.00) in serving as the City's portion of the matching funds required for these grants from which this amount shall be provided, by the City, in the form of the financial equivalent of the administrative tasks and duties provided by those City officials/employees participating in these projects (no monetary appropriation, from the City, is associated with these matching funds); and

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED the Claremont City Council hereby raises and appropriates the sum of Twenty-Two Thousand Dollars (\$22,000.00), which shall have no impact on the City's tax rate, for the purposes stated herein.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this Resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke on this resolution. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

A motion was made by Councilor Mooshian and seconded by Council O’Hearne to adopt Resolution 2022-25 Emergency Operations Plan (EOP) Update Grant and Continuity of Operations (COOP) EMPG Grant Project.

Councilor Mooshian read resolution into the record.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

License Agreement for Agricultural Use

Gary LeClair has had a City License to grow corn on a parcel of city-owned land, Map 125, Lot 7, for approximately ten years. His most recent five-year license has expired and he has asked for a new license. A portion of Map 125, Lot 7 has been under Option Agreement with Steel Mill Solar which has expired, however that parcel may be considered in the future for solar power or other use. We recommend that a license be approved for one year only while the Council is considering future use. The agreement would be subject to payment of property taxes levied on his use of the property and subject to a provision that the license may be terminated, without penalty, if the City sells or otherwise develops the property

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Beliveau that the Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designees to negotiate and enter into a License Agreement with Gary LeClair to use a portion of Parcel 152-7 for agricultural use for one (1) year, subject to payment of property taxes levied on Licensee's use of the property and subject to a provision that the license may be terminated or revoked, without penalty, if the City sells or otherwise develops the property.

Voice vote: Motion carried 9-0

Off Highway Recreational Vehicles on Class V Roads Discussion

OPTION 1:

Propose a minor amendment to the City's Code in Chapter 19, Article X, Section 19-221 in order to allow use of certain designated sections of particular Class V roads (as the Ordinance only cites to Class VI roads at present). After this change in the Ordinance, the City would still proceed in the same manner as before in that, the City could only grant a permit, for one (1) year, to SCATV for use of these Class VI and identified Class V roads within the City for OHRV use (if, at all). In doing so, the City would be obligated, by statute, to first conduct a public hearing with notice to abutters. The cost of this notice requirement can be, by statute, passed onto SCATV as the requesting party for such permission. SCATV opposes this process given the substantial cost associated with the annual notice to abutters for said hearing.

OPTION 2:

Propose the changes to the City's Code, as stated above, as well as an amendment to the permitting process of the Council for OHRV use of the City's roads. The Council possesses the ability to alter the timeframe for the permission it grants, for such OHRV use, from which it could expand same to any period of time it wishes (for example, the permit could be for 2, 5, 10 or any other number of years that the Council chooses). The change to the City Council's permit process would not require any legislative act, but merely a vote of the Council at the next public hearing, under RSA 215-A:6 (IX), in deciding the request from SCATV. If the Council extends the permit, neither the City Council nor SCATV would be obligated to undergo the hearing process, as set forth in RSA 215-A:6 (IX), until the expiration of the permit (assuming that SCATV pursued a new permit for additional years of use) or in the event that the Council chose to conduct such a hearing to consider the revocation of the current permit.

OPTION 3:

Propose a different amendment to the City Code (as referenced above) in order to grant, for an ongoing and indefinite basis, the City's permission to utilize these Class VI and identified Class V roads. The language of this proposed change would eliminate the need for the City Council to provide a permit for such use. The "right" to such access, by OHRVs, would be by and through this municipal legislation from which neither the Council nor SCATV would need to undergo any further hearings or permit procedures in order to allow such OHRV use (assuming this Ordinance passed). The only way to revoke this permission would be by and through the ordinance process for such change to the City's Code as well as a public hearing pursuant to RSA 215-A:6 (IX).

At 8:40 p.m. Shawn Tanguy, City Attorney joined the City Council meeting via Zoom, to further explain these options.

Attorney Tanguy addressed the following two issues:

1. Shawn stated in order for a municipality to allow OHRV use on municipal roads this can only be done by and through ordinance or by-law. The city has adopted a somewhat comprehensive code to address OHRV use. Attorney Tanguy noted, after looking through the City's Code it became abundantly apparent the City Council only approved OHRV use for Class VI Roads, and never addressed Class V Roads within the Code. Attorney Tanguy explained the problem is that the City doesn't have the legislative authority at this time to grant permission for the SCATV club to use the few identified Class V Roads for OHRV use. Attorney Tanguy explained to the Council he will need to draft an Ordinance, then proceed to get the Ordinance approved by Council to allow OHRV use on certain designated Class V Roads.
2. The second issue Attorney Tanguy brought to Council is the way the City has designed the portion of the code that specifies OHRV use is that the Code requires an organization to request permission annually for use of those roads relative to OHRV use. In order to grant this permission, the Council has to conduct a public hearing by state law. In doing so, all abutters to Class V, and Class VI Roads will need a notice of public hearing. The cost of notification can be put onto the applying party in this case the SCATV club. When reviewing the cost of notifications to all abutters the cost came to approximately \$1000.00, this cost could incur annually.

Attorney Tanguy identified the three options presented and wanted to make sure the Council addressed all options before bringing an ordinance to Council.

Steve Wilkie, president of the Sullivan County ATV Club, stated to Council that Class VI Roads are open to all vehicles, if his club did not ask for permission these roads would still be open for use. Mr. Wilkie then described the extensive work the Sullivan County ATV Club has done for these roads.

Councilor Stone Commented he would support option three.

Mr. MacLean added that option three would give relief to the Sullivan County ATV Club and agrees that the SCATV Club does great work for the community.

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor Belliveau to direct the City Attorney to proceed with and draft option three.

Mayor Girard asked for any further discussion.

Walter Elhardt, Vice president of the Sullivan County ATV club shared concern for abutter notification. Mr. Elhardt asked why we still needed to do this process.

Councilor Stone asked for a roll call vote on his motion, and asked that further discussion on maintenance relative to Class VI Roads be a separate issue.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - no

Stone - yes

Matteau - no

Koloski - no

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 6-3

Mr. Wilkie brought forward a Permission form to the Council relative to conducting maintenance projects on Class VI Roads. The submittal of this form would allow the SCATV to apply for grants.

Attorney Tanguay noted there were no issues with the Council supporting the submission of the permission form for grant application relative to maintenance on trail systems that may include Class VI Roads.

Mr. Wilkie shared with the Council this form states to attach the minutes of approval meeting. Mr. Wilkie asked the Council for approval to conduct work on Cat Hole Road which includes three culverts, and the barriers which keep people out. Mr. Wilkie suggested the approval may satisfy the Bureau of Trails for Grant-In-Aid.

A motion was made by Councilor Beliveau and seconded by Councilor Stone to authorize the City Manager to enter into an agreement on behalf of the Sullivan County ATV Club relative to maintenance, trail work, and grant application.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0

Dispatch Update

City Manager Morris requested permission from the Claremont City Council to obtain a One Million Dollar bond on August 26, 2020. City Council granted this permission. At the time of this Bond request the City of Claremont was still working on the possibility of a regional communications center. The exact cost of the equipment was not known and City Manager Morris believed this bond would cover the cost of the Claremont equipment with the hope that the regional center could be a reality and there would be cost sharing for the purchase of radio equipment. As we moved forward with this project the possibility for a regional communications center failed and is no longer being discussed.

As part of the conceptual design completed by CTA, they broke this project into four phases. The estimate that CTA completed for the cost of all four of the phases exceeded the one million bond that the City of Claremont had obtained. The first two phases of this project can be covered with the existing bonds based on the estimates. The next two phases could be completed as funding becomes available or if savings are located. The estimates that were provided were based on market prices from previous contracts that CTA had completed as well as estimates for work that must be completed.

Chief Mark Chase explained the dispatch update to the Council. Chief Chase noted an RFP has been put out, and expecting to see these bids sometime in May, while hoping to have this project in place by 2023.

Councilor Koloski asked if the current equipment has a trade-in value. Chief Chase stated there won't be a trade-in component for the CTA, there could be an opportunity to sell when the time comes to get rid of older equipment.

Ms. Richmond stated she reached out to those who oversee the Bond and there is no issue relative to a time frame for spending this bond.

Resolution 2022-26 ACERT Grant Continuation-Public Hearing

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire has been awarded a United States Department of Justice Victims of Crime Grant in the amount of \$110,000.00 for a one-year period to fund the position of ACERT Coordinator. This position facilitates the Adverse Childhood Experiences Response Team (ACERT) for the Greater Claremont Area; and

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and expend the funds for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to accept a grant in the amount of \$110,000.00 from the United States Department of Justice to fund the ACERT Coordinator position; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to raise and appropriate the sum of \$110,000.00 for the Police Department (from off-setting grant revenue) for the purpose of hiring and training of said position for the Claremont Police Department; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Chief Chase updated the Council on the City of Claremont Police Department's ACERT Coordinator. After the department was given the grant, an ACERT Coordinator was hired. This coordinator was here for 2-3 months and left. Last fall Chief Chase started working on a replacement ACERT coordinator. Stephanie Durkee, was hired and has been with us for about 6 months. Chief Chase shared to the Council she is doing a phenomenal job; however, Ms. Durkee needs more time to train. The Attorney General's office has offered an extension for one year that is fully funded and without matching funds to continue the ACERT Coordinator for the City of Claremont Police Department in conjunction with the school district. Chief Chase made note that it's a possibility funding this program will be granted again next year however, if it is not fully funded by this grant Chief Chase stated the Claremont Police Department will be coming to Council asking for funding. Chief Chase expressed this is a very valuable program.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Stone to adopt Resolution 2022-26 ACERT Grant Continuation

Councilor Koloski read the resolution into the record

May Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes
Motion carried 9-0

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

None.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

NON-PUBLIC SESSION PURSUANT TO RSA 91-A:3,II(b) – HIRING

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to enter Nonpublic Session pursuant to RSA 91-A:3, II(c), and to invite Mr. MacLean into the session.

Roll call vote:
Contois - yes
O’Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau – yes
Mooshian-yes
Girard -yes
Motion carried: 9-0

Entered nonpublic session at 10:00 p.m.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to exit the Non-Public Session.

Roll call vote:
Contois - yes
O’Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau – yes

Mooshian-yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Public session reconvened at 10:15 p.m.

Motion made by Councilor Stone, seconded by Councilor O’Hearne, to seal minutes because it is determined that divulgence of this information affect adversely the reputation of any person other than a member of the public body itself.

Roll call vote:
Contois - yes
O’Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - no
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau – yes
Mooshian-yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-1

ADJOURNMENT

At 10:18 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor Beliveau and seconded by Councilor Mooshian to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council